

100 Days of Linux - Day 002

Title: Navigating Directories with `cd`

Today's Goal

Learn how Linux folders are organized and how to move between directories using the `cd` command while reviewing `pwd` and `ls`.

Why This Matters

Every developer and data engineer navigates folders constantly when working with projects, scripts, logs, and data files.

Commands of the Day

`cd`

Syntax: `cd DIRECTORY`

Explanation: Changes your current directory.

Common Uses:

`cd ..` (parent folder)

`cd ~` (home directory)

`cd /` (root directory)

Example: `cd Documents`

Beginner Lesson

A directory is simply a folder. Linux has a tree-like structure. When you open WSL, you start in your home directory. Use `pwd` to know where you are, `ls` to see what is inside, and `cd` to move around.

Practice Questions

1. Display your current working directory.
2. Move to your Home directory using a Linux command.
3. Move to the root (`/`) directory and display your location.
4. Return to your Home directory and list all files, including hidden ones.
5. Move to the parent directory from your current location and display the path.

Hints

Think about special directory shortcuts like `~`, `/` and `..`.

Mini Challenge

Go to your Home directory, then the root directory, return Home again, and finally print your current directory.

Common Mistakes

Using Windows-style backslashes (`\`). Linux uses forward slashes (`/`).

Did You Know?

Everything in Linux starts from a single root directory: `/`.

Pro Tip

Press the Tab key to auto-complete directory names.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: pwd

Q2: cd ~

Q3: cd / then pwd

Q4: cd ~ then ls -la

Q5: cd .. then pwd

Homework

Practice moving between Home (/home/username), Root (/), and the parent directory using cd until it feels natural.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll create your first directories using mkdir and learn how to organize files.